

YOUR FULL REPORT

Do you push people away?

Guarded at times

Score band: 14–26 points · Relationships

What this report covers

A closer look at the moments when self-protection starts creating confusing distance.

Inside:

1. The closeness cues that trigger you
2. How to ask for space without disappearing
3. A low-pressure reconnection script

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Your result

Guarded at times (14–26 points)

You may reach for distance when closeness feels uncertain. That protection probably makes sense in context, but it can confuse people who do not know what is happening.

Try this next

The next time you pull back, send one honest sentence instead of disappearing.

Your practical guide

A closer look at the moments when self-protection starts creating confusing distance.

1 The closeness cues that trigger you

Your guard goes up around specific closeness cues, and naming them is the whole game. Common ones: someone says "we need to talk," a partner wants to define the relationship, a friend asks for emotional support two weeks in a row, or affection arrives right after a conflict. Notice what your body does first — the urge to check your phone, sudden tiredness, a mental list of their flaws appearing from nowhere. That flaw-list is especially worth catching: focusing on what is wrong with them is often the mind's way of creating distance without having to admit you are scared. When you catch a cue, label it silently — "closeness cue, guard rising" — before you act.

2 How to ask for space without disappearing

You can take space without taking yourself away. The formula is boring and it works: name the need, name the return, keep the thread warm. "I need tonight to recharge — I will text you tomorrow morning" gives the other person everything silence withholds: a reason, a timeline, and proof they are still on your mind. What to avoid: the vague "I am just busy lately" with no follow-up, replying with one-word answers for days, or canceling without proposing an alternative. If you need longer than a day, say so and check in briefly mid-gap — a thirty-second "thinking of you, still need a couple days" prevents a short retreat from feeling like a disappearance.

3 A low-pressure reconnection script

For the next reconnection, try language that is warm, brief, and pressure-free. After a short withdrawal: "Hey — I went quiet for a few days. Nothing is wrong; I needed to recharge. I would love to catch up this week if you are free." Notice what it does not contain: no over-apology, no dramatic explanation, no demand for reassurance. If the gap was longer, add one specific acknowledgment: "I know I dropped our plans and that was not fair to you." Then propose something concrete and low-stakes — coffee, a walk, a twenty-minute call. Most people are far more forgiving of distance than of being left to guess what it meant.